

COOL Label Retention for Inspectors

Country of origin labeling laws currently apply to our uncooked and unseasoned seafood, poultry and lamb items. The items that we display in our meat cases must be labeled accordingly. Records at the warehouse level must be kept in the event that an inspector asks you to prove where an item originated.

Review with all Meat Department employees the following information. Be sure these directives are implemented and followed at all times.

- The country of origin, production date and description must be kept from each item.
- This label is to accompany the cut product to the wrapping station where the meat wrapper will place with other labels collected that day.
- At the end of the production day, the meat wrapper will overwrap the labels in a blue 25 tray and place a label (from PLU 999) on the package. This label will have the current day's date being the *Pack Date* and the date that the tray can be thrown away which is the *Sell Date*.

PLU 999 Printing Instructions:

The Mettler Toledo Scale Label can only be printed from the master scale.

1. Go to option *Label* mode.
2. Go to label *Print Manual* with a weight on the scale.
3. Print the scale label.

- The label is currently loaded with an 11 day retention. This means you will always have 11 trays on-hand in the back receiving area. Store today's tray with the other trays in a lugger. Discard the tray from 11 days ago.
- Poultry box end labels do not need to be retained. The COOL information on our poultry is placed on the product by the packer and the USDA has advised that this is sufficient to substantiate our claim.
- Lamb Leg and Lamb Rack box end labels do not need to be retained. The COOL information on these items is placed on the product by the packer and the USDA has advised that this is sufficient to substantiate our claim. However, box end labels for Lamb Loins must be retained since we remove this item from the vacuum package.



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